

Week 1 Practicum Setup, Baseline & Work Log

Submission Format: Markdown (.md) or Word Document (.docx) file upload + Personal GitHub URL Link

Due Date: Sunday, September 6, 2026 by 11:59 PM EDT

Purpose & Account Notice

Before beginning your virtual internship, hands-on technical work, and certification preparation, we need to establish your baseline skills and practicum goals.

Important — Personal GitHub Account Requirement:

You must host your portfolio on a **personal GitHub account** rather than a school-issued account. Using your personal account ensures you retain full ownership, control, and access to your project evidence after graduation to share directly with prospective employers.

GitHub Portfolio Standards & Privacy Guidelines

When building a public professional portfolio, what you **exclude** is just as important as what you publish:

- **What MUST be Public (Your Career Evidence):** Repository README.md, technical write-ups, lab documentation, Forage/K7 deliverables, and a clean technical resume.
- **What MUST REMAIN PRIVATE or EXCLUDED:** API keys, passwords, access tokens, home addresses, personal phone numbers, or proprietary system IP addresses/logs.

Required Submission Content

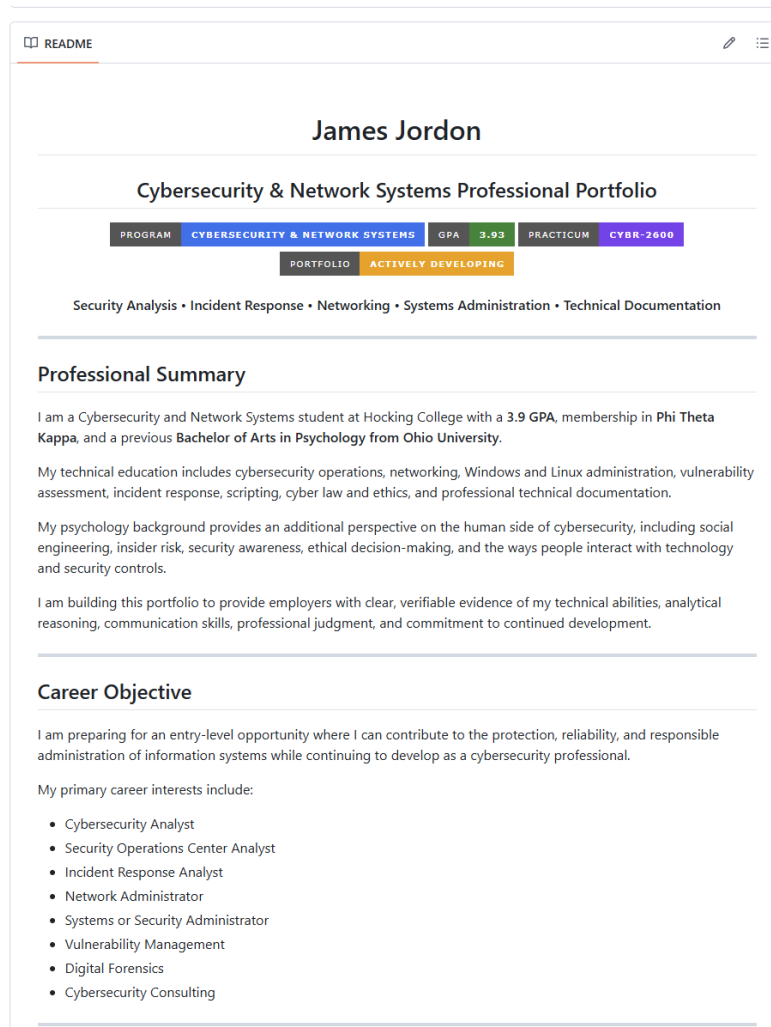
Complete your assignment as a **Markdown (.md)** file or **Word Document (.docx)** containing the following required sections and screenshots:

Part 1 — GitHub Portfolio Setup & Link

- Provide the public URL to your newly created personal GitHub repository (e.g., <https://github.com/>)[<https://github.com/>][your-username]/CYBR-2600-Professional-Portfolio).

[jjordon237/CYBR-2600-Professional-Portfolio: Cyber 2600 portfolio showcasing hands-on work in cybersecurity, including threat analysis, incident response, risk assessment, policy and compliance, cyber law and ethics, network security, and defensive strategies. Created by James Jordon to document technical growth, critical thinking, and practical security skills.](#)

- Include a **screenshot of your repository root** showing your initialized README.md and required directory structure (forage/, k7-cyber/, certification/, technical-work/, career-materials/, final-practicum/).



Part 2 — Technical Baseline

- **Strengths:** Identify 3 technical areas where you currently feel strongest. For each, briefly describe something you can actually do that demonstrates that skill.
- **Growth Areas:** Identify 3 areas where you would like additional experience during the practicum.

Current strengths

1. **Technical troubleshooting and problem-solving.** I am able with reasonable degree of certainty to systematically diagnose and resolve hardware and software issues within a computer system, cellular device, IoT device, or tablet. Utilizing methodological reasoning and logic, I troubleshoot, evaluate likely causes, test the potential issues, and document results with professional communication.
2. **Cybersecurity analysis, law, ethics, and policy evaluation.** My technical writing skills, previous employment history, and academic background have given me skills to evaluate cybersecurity analyses, codes of ethics, laws, and corporate policies.
3. **Research, professional writing, and technical documentation.** Due to my previous background as well as my grasp of the vernacular, my professional writing skills, thorough research through primary sources, and technical documentation that has been used as evidence in legal proceedings.

Development areas

1. Hands-on SOC operations, SIEM tools, and log analysis. I would like to have more hands on SOC operational testing and experimentation, SIEM tool usage, and learning how to properly analyze logs for significant and relevant evidence and the tools needed to do so.
2. Python, Bash, and PowerShell security automation. I need more experience working specifically with PowerShell, Python, JavaScript, and Bash. I also need more experience working with Kali Linux and utilizing command prompt.
3. Cloud security and enterprise security environments. I also need more experience working with Cloud security as well as the AWS and other cloud-based systems.

Part 3 — Career Direction

- Identify 2 or 3 cybersecurity, networking, or IT career roles that currently interest you and explain why.

1. Cybersecurity/SOC Analyst

2. Incident Response or Digital Forensics Specialist

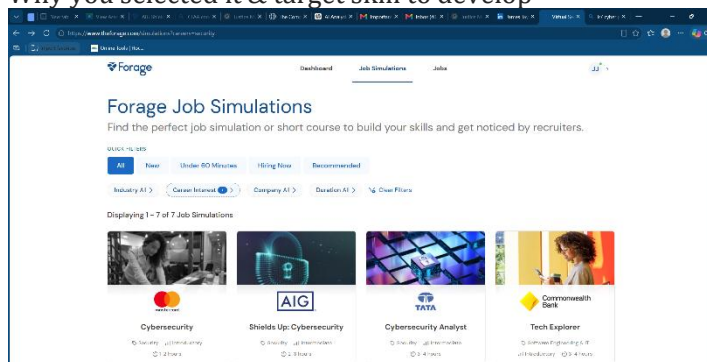
3. Cybersecurity Governance, Risk, Compliance, or Consulting

I believe these three careers would allow me to combine my past employment and academic history, technical abilities, investigative reasoning and professional writing skills to help create a fulfilling career. After learning and utilizing OSINT throughout the Cyber Skyline NCL tournament, analysis appears to be an interesting and worthwhile career path.

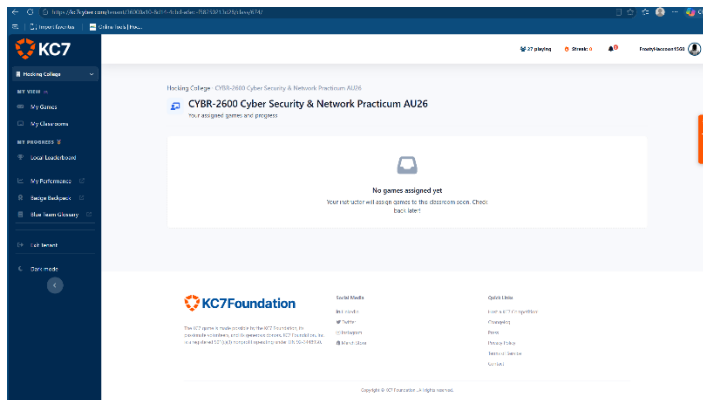
Part 4 — Forge Exploration

Identify 2 Forge virtual job simulations that interest you. For each, provide:

- Organization & Simulation Title
- Type of work involved
- Why you selected it & target skill to develop



1. Mastercard- I will be utilizing the Mastercard Cybersecurity Job Simulation with completed certification to gain hands-on experience and knowledge against phishing scams and how to detect them.
2. Commonwealth Bank-I will be utilizing their Introduction to Cybersecurity Job Simulation as another hands-on method of learning how to create and visually represent datasets to stakeholders via professional communication and technical writing skills.
3. AIG-Shields Up Cybersecurity- After completing Python, I will be utilizing this Job Simulation training to learn the tactics of fighting Ransomware through Python scripting. This should give me more relevant on-the-job training that will help me pursue my goals as a Cybersecurity analyst.



Part 5 — Certification Direction

- Identify 1 or 2 industry certifications you are considering, why they interest you, and your current readiness level.

Certifications I am planning on gaining this semester include AWS Cloud Foundations, AWS Skill Builder, CompTIA A+, CompTIA SEC+, and either my CEH+ or My CompTIA PenTest+ exams. Whilst I am well aware this is difficult, even completing a minimum of two to three would be ideal for my new career launch starting with Cloud Foundations through AWS.

Part 6 — Setup Confirmation & Baseline Artifacts

Confirm the following items (include screenshots where requested):

- [X] Personal GitHub repository created and linked
- [X] Baseline resume/skills outline saved and pushed to career-materials/ (include screenshot/link)
- [X] Forge portal access confirmed (include screenshot)
- [X] K7 Cyber portal access confirmed (include screenshot)
- [X] Security & Privacy Check: Verified no API keys, passwords, or sensitive personal data are public
- [X] Weekly Thursday check-in added to your calendar

Part 7 — Practicum Goal Statement

Complete this statement with a specific, actionable answer:

"By the end of CYBR-2600 practicum, my plan is to transform the knowledge and skills I have developed throughout the Cybersecurity and Network Systems program into clear, employer-ready evidence of my abilities. During the practicum, I will strengthen my experience with Cloud-based and CompTIA certifications, SOC operations, SIEM tools, log analysis, scripting, security automation, and cloud environments through hands-on technical work, KC7 Cyber investigations, and Forge job simulations. I will also assess my readiness for an industry certification, address identified knowledge gaps, and document my progress through measurable practice results and a targeted study plan. Each major activity will be organized within my GitHub portfolio using professional documentation that explains the objective, methodology, evidence, results, and lessons learned. By the end of the practicum, I intend to present a polished portfolio, updated résumé, and final defense that demonstrates my technical competence, analytical reasoning, ethical judgment, communication skills, and readiness to pursue an entry-level cybersecurity or information-technology position.

Part 8 — Week 1 Professional Work Log

- Attach your completed **Week 1 Work Log** (.md or .docx) documenting your setup activities and check-in preparation.

Grading Breakdown (10 Points Total)

- **Technical Strengths & Growth Areas (2 pts):** Clear baseline reflection with practical examples.
- **Career & Certification Direction (2 pts):** Thoughtful selection of career paths and cert targets.
- **Forage Exploration (2 pts):** Identified two relevant virtual job simulations with clear rationale.
- **GitHub & Setup Verification (2 pts):** Correct personal repository link, screenshots, and privacy check.
- **Goal Statement & Work Log (2 pts):** Meaningful goal statement and completed Week 1 work log entry.